

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Penny Pincher

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Penny Pincher

Eccentric Private Collector

Penny is convinced that every museum object would look better in her hallway. Penny collects small paintings, strange decorative objects, and stories about who owned them before she did.

- Asks **Hugh Bidder** for auction previews and always disputes his estimates.
- Shows **Vincent Van Faux** photos of paintings and asks for a free valuation.
- Has compared auction finds with **Tess Tament**. Penny prefers a bargain **Tess** has overlooked.

ACTING TIPS

Eccentric, charming, nosy, unexpectedly shrewd. Ask questions that sound casual and are not.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Penny Pincher. Some things in this museum belonged to my family, so you'd think I'd at least get a discount on tickets. I'm delighted about all the free food tonight, though!

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Penny Pincher

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

One decorative object in the exhibition once belonged to your family. You believe Grant acquired it through a manipulative private sale decades ago.

Your other secret

You brought old correspondence proving your family contested that sale and planned to confront him tonight.

Conversations to start

- Ask Anya Tique whether she remembers the decorative object from your family.
- Ask Saul D. Bid how old private sales can be traced. If he is absent, try Hugh Bidder.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1** *Look behind the rectangle that brings distant worlds into the living room.*
- 2** *A vase has swallowed a document. Rescue it without disturbing the china.*
- 3** *Seek the green lamp; its nearest neighbor is part of this investigation.*



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Penny Pincher

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The family letters challenge Grant's account of the sale. I brought them intending to confront him and left out the letter implicating my grandfather. Grant knew the missing part and offered to buy our silence. I was asking the museum to tell a history I had not told honestly myself.

IF MURDERER

The family letters challenge Grant's account of the sale. I brought them intending to confront him and left out the letter implicating my grandfather. Grant knew the missing part and offered to buy our silence. I would not accept his price or let him announce his version unchallenged.



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Penny Pincher

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Penny Pincher

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I burned the photocopy of Grant's offer on the smoking terrace. It named a price for my family's silence. I had withheld the letter that explained my grandfather's part in the sale and did not want another guest reading the offer. The originals remained in my case. Grant watched me destroy the copy and said there were others. I believed him. I had come demanding justice and was concealing the part that made my family harder to defend.

IF MURDERER

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Penny Pincher

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The letter I withheld identifies my grandfather's part in the sale. The family solicitor retained its transcript before tonight. Grant's offer to buy our silence is written beside that transcript. I wanted a cleaner family history; the letter will not give me one. Both papers can be examined without taking my version on trust.

IF MURDERER

I omitted the letter about my grandfather from the family display. Grant knew what it said and offered to buy our silence. I had come to argue over the sale instead of accepting his price. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my family-letter case. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass to make him look at the disputed sale date.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



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Penny Pincher

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I burned the copy of his offer and withheld the letter implicating my grandfather. The family solicitor retained its transcript. I did not kill Grant. I will release the letter and stop presenting a family history with the difficult page removed. His offer to buy our silence will accompany it.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my family-letter case when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He offered to buy the family's silence. I killed him rather than reveal what my grandfather's letter admitted.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.